

sometimes criticized as old-fashioned by the time of his death in France in 1936.

KEY WORKS: Symphony No.4 in E-flat major, Op. 48, 1893; The Seasons (ballet), Op. 67, 1900; Violin Concerto in A minor, Op. 82, 1904; Concerto for Alto Saxophone, Op. 109, 1934

Ferruccio Busoni

1866–1924, ITALIAN

A composer, pianist, and theoretician, Busoni was a major figure in the transition from Romanticism to Modernism. A son of musicians, he was a child prodigy in both piano and composition. He led a cosmopolitan life from an early age and, although born in Tuscany, was more German than Italian in culture. His spectacular performances as a virtuoso and his transcriptions of Bach for piano often tended to overshadow his own compositions. Innovative and eclectic, his extensive oeuvre included a piano concerto with a choral finale, works based on Amerindian folk song, and experiments with atonality. Busoni's treatise *Entwurf einer neuen Ästhetik der Tonkunst* (Sketch of a New Aesthetic of Music), written in 1907, was a prophetic manifesto of